

# Deploy Your GitHub App to Vercel

A step-by-step guide that anyone can follow, even with no prior experience. Read the big picture first, then follow Parts 1 to 3.

## Big picture (read this first)

Think of it like this:

- **GitHub** is a locker where your app's code is stored.
- **Vercel** is a service that takes the code from the locker, turns it into a working website, and gives it an internet address (URL) that anyone can open.

You don't copy code between them by hand. You connect them once, and after that Vercel watches your GitHub locker for changes.

## Part 1: Get ready (about 5 minutes)

### **Step 1. Check that your code is on GitHub**

1. Go to **github.com** and log in.
2. Open your repository (a repository is just a project folder on GitHub).
3. Look at the file list. You should see your app's files.
  - If it's a React, Next.js, or Vite app, you'll see a file called **package.json**.
  - If it's a plain website, you'll see **index.html**.

If your files aren't there yet, upload or push them first, then continue.

### **Step 2. Create a Vercel account**

1. Go to **vercel.com** and click **Sign Up**.
2. Choose **Continue with GitHub**. This is the easiest option because the two accounts connect right away.
3. A GitHub window will ask for permission. Click **Authorize Vercel**.

### **Step 3. Pick the repository Vercel can see**

GitHub may ask which repositories Vercel can access. For safety, choose **Only select repositories** and pick just your app's repository. Then click **Install** or **Save**.

## Part 2: Deploy your app (about 5 minutes)

### **Step 4. Start a new project**

1. On your Vercel dashboard (the home screen after logging in), click the **Add New...** button.
2. Choose **Project**.

### **Step 5. Import your repository**

1. Vercel shows a list of your GitHub repositories.

2. Find your app's repository and click **Import** next to it.

**Tip:** If you don't see your repository, follow the link to adjust GitHub permissions and select it, as in Step 3.

### Step 6. Check the settings

This screen is called **Configure Project**. Most of the time, you change nothing here.

| Setting                   | What it means                              | What to do                                              |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Project Name              | The name in your web address               | Pick something simple, like my-quiz-app                 |
| Framework Preset          | The type of app                            | Vercel usually detects it. For plain HTML, choose Other |
| Root Directory            | Where your app lives inside the repository | Leave it as ./ unless your app is in a subfolder        |
| Build and Output Settings | Instructions for preparing your app        | Leave the default values unless you know what to change |
| Environment Variables     | Secret values such as API keys             | Add them here, never in your code (see the note below)  |

**Note on secrets:** If your app uses a password or API key, open **Environment Variables**, type the name (for example, API\_KEY) in the first box, paste the value in the second box, and click **Add**. Never type secret values directly into your code on GitHub, because anyone can see them.

### Step 7. Click Deploy

1. Click the big **Deploy** button.
2. Vercel shows a progress screen with a list of steps. This takes about 1 to 2 minutes.
3. When it finishes, you'll see a celebration screen with a preview of your website.

### Step 8. Open your live website

1. Click **Visit** or **Continue to Dashboard**.
2. Your app is now online at an address like `https://my-quiz-app.vercel.app`
3. Share that link with anyone. It works on phones and computers.

## Part 3: Updating your app later

You never need to deploy again by hand. Vercel updates automatically.

1. Change your code on your computer.
2. Save it to GitHub. In the terminal (or in GitHub Desktop), run:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Changed the homepage color"
git push
```

1. Vercel notices the new push and redeploys by itself. Refresh your site in about a minute.

Pushing to the **main** branch (the main version of your code) updates the live website.

## When something goes wrong

### *The deployment shows a red "Error" or "Build Failed" message*

1. Click the failed deployment.
2. Click **Build Logs** (a list of everything Vercel did).
3. Scroll to the first red line. It usually says what went wrong, such as a missing file or a package that couldn't be installed.
4. Fix that problem on your computer, then push to GitHub again.

### *The website opens but shows "404: Not Found"*

- Check the **Root Directory** setting. It should point to the folder that contains your app.
- For plain HTML, make sure the main file is named **index.html**.

### *The site works but a feature is broken*

- You probably forgot an environment variable. Go to **Project Settings**, then **Environment Variables**, add it, then click **Redeploy** from the Deployments tab.

## Words you'll see (a mini glossary)

| Word                 | Meaning                                                  |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Repository (repo)    | A project folder stored on GitHub                        |
| Commit               | A saved snapshot of your changes                         |
| Push                 | Sending your saved changes up to GitHub                  |
| Deploy               | Putting your app online so anyone can use it             |
| Build                | The step where Vercel prepares your app for the internet |
| Environment variable | A secret setting kept outside your code                  |
| Deployment log       | The step-by-step report of what happened during a deploy |

## Summary in four lines

1. Put your code on GitHub.
2. Sign up at Vercel with GitHub.
3. Click **Add New**, then **Project**, import your repo, and press **Deploy**.
4. To update, push to GitHub and Vercel does the rest.